Getting Started with SLURM and Python Environments on an HPC Cluster

Md Shahriar Forhad
shahriar.forhad.eee@gmail.com
https://shahriar88.github.io/

May 2, 2026

Contents

1 Introduction to CRADLE **5**
1.1 Introduction . . . 5
1.1.1 Logging In to CRADLE . . . 5
1.2 A Minimal SLURM Job Script Example . . . 6
1.3 Understanding Key `#SBATCH` Directives . . . 6
1.3.1 Number of Nodes: `-N` . . . 7
1.3.2 Partition (Queue): `-p` . . . 7
1.3.3 GPU Request: `-gres` . . . 7
1.3.4 CPU Cores per Task: `-cpus-per-task` . . . 7
1.3.5 Time Limit: `-time` . . . 8
1.3.6 Summary Table of Core Directives . . . 8
1.4 Why Use Python Environments on an HPC Cluster? . . . 8

2 CRADLE COMMAND **11**
2.1 Transferring Files to and from the CRADLE Cluster . . . 11
2.1.1 Using `scp` (Secure Copy) . . . 11
2.1.2 Working with Directories in the Terminal . . . 12
2.1.3 Cloning a GitHub Repository . . . 12
2.1.4 Recommended Best Practices . . . 12
2.2 Cloning a Shared TensorFlow Environment . . . 13
2.2.1 Step 1: Install the cloning tool (one time) . . . 13
2.2.2 Step 2: Clone the shared environment . . . 13
2.2.3 Step 3: Activate the cloned environment . . . 14
2.2.4 Step 4: Add new packages (example: `pandas`) . . . 14
2.2.5 Step 5: Use the cloned environment in your SLURM job . . . 14
2.2.6 Mental Model Summary . . . 15
2.3 Creating Your Own Python Virtual Environment . . . 15
2.3.1 Option A (Recommended for CPU-Only): Create from Scratch . . . 15
2.3.2 Option B (Best for GPU): Clone an Optimized Shared Environment . . . 16
2.4 Verifying Your Environment and Common Pitfalls . . . 16
2.4.1 Verifying Python and GPU Visibility . . . 16
2.4.2 Common Mistakes to Avoid . . . 17
2.4.3 Quick Decision Guide . . . 17
2.5 Using a PyTorch Environment on CRADLE . . . 17
2.5.1 Minimal GPU Verification Checklist . . . 17
2.6 Using Micromamba and Portable Conda Environments on the HPC Cluster . . . 18
2.6.1 Exporting a Portable Conda Environment on Your PC . . . 18

2.6.2 Copying the YAML File to CRADLE . . . 18
2.6.3 Installing Micromamba in Your Home Directory . . . 19
2.6.4 Creating a Micromamba Environment from the YAML File . . . 19
2.6.5 Activating the Environment on CRADLE . . . 19
2.6.6 Using a Micromamba Environment in a SLURM Job . . . 20
2.6.7 Verifying GPU Support Inside the Environment . . . 21
2.6.8 Best Practices and Common Pitfalls for Micromamba on HPC . . . 21
2.7 Worked Examples: Environments and SLURM Job Scripts . . . 21
2.7.1 Creating a New CPU-Only Environment . . . 22
2.7.2 Cloning a Shared GPU-Optimized TensorFlow Environment . . . 22
2.7.3 Selecting an Environment in a Job Script . . . 22
2.7.4 Installing Libraries After Environment Activation . . . 23
2.7.5 Checking and Verifying Resources . . . 23
2.8 PyTorch DataParallel (DP) on SLURM . . . 26
2.8.1 When to Use DataParallel . . . 26
2.8.2 When *Not* to Use DataParallel . . . 26
2.8.3 Minimal DataParallel Training Skeleton . . . 27
2.8.4 SLURM Script for DataParallel (single node) . . . 29
2.8.5 DP vs DDP: Practical Comparison . . . 29
2.8.6 Common DP Pitfalls . . . 29
2.8.7 Rule of Thumb . . . 30
2.9 PyTorch Distributed Data Parallel (DDP) on SLURM . . . 30
2.9.1 What You Need (Checklist) . . . 30
2.9.2 Minimal DDP Training Skeleton (single file) . . . 30
2.9.3 SLURM Script for DDP (single node, 4 GPUs) . . . 32
2.9.4 SLURM Script for DDP (2 nodes, 4 GPUs per node) . . . 32
2.9.5 Common DDP Pitfalls (Fast Debug List) . . . 33

3 Example Commands **35**
3.1 Example Commands for File Transfer . . . 35
3.1.1 Copy files from/to CRADLE . . . 39
3.1.2 Installing Anaconda or Miniconda on CRADLE . . . 41
3.1.3 Example SLURM Job Script Using a Conda Environment . . . 42
3.1.4 Sample Run code for sh . . . 43
3.1.5 Launching Jupyter Notebook on CRADLE . . . 47
3.1.6 Troubleshooting Deleting a Folder . . . 48
3.1.7 Single Node, CPU-Only Job . . . 49
3.1.8 Quick Mapping: Which Example to Use? . . . 53
3.2 Summary . . . 53

Chapter 1

Introduction to CRADLE

1.1 Introduction

For more details https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/linux-unix/scp-command-in-linux-with-examples/

This short tutorial explains how to:

- Write a basic SLURM batch script for running a TensorFlow job.
- Understand key `#SBATCH` directives, including nodes, partitions, GPUs, and time limits.
- Use and extend a shared TensorFlow environment on the cluster.
- Create your own Python virtual environments for CPU and GPU workloads.

All examples are designed to be copied directly into a terminal or SLURM job script on a typical HPC system (e.g., a university cluster).

1.1.1 Logging In to CRADLE

Once you have received your user account information, you can log in to the CRADLE cluster from a terminal or command-line prompt using your University credentials.

Step 1: Connect to the University Network (VPN)

If you are off campus, you must first connect to the University network using the approved VPN software. Install and start the VPN client, then log in with your University credentials. Once the VPN connection is active, you can reach the CRADLE login node.

Step 2: SSH into the Cluster

To log in, use `ssh` with your assigned username. In the examples below, replace `username` with your actual cluster username.

```
ssh username@login.cradle.university.edu
```

You will be prompted for your password:

```
username@login.cradle.university.edu's password:
```

After you enter your password correctly, you should see a prompt indicating that you are now on the cluster login node, similar to:

```
[username\@login001 ~]\$
```

At this point you are logged into CRADLE and ready to work with SLURM, Python environments, and the other tools described in this tutorial.

1.2 A Minimal SLURM Job Script Example

Listing 1.1 shows a basic SLURM job script that runs a TensorFlow test script in a shared environment.

Listing 1.1: Basic SLURM job script with TensorFlow environment

```bash
#!/bin/bash

# Job identification
#SBATCH --job-name=myFirstJob

# Standard output and error files (%j = job ID)
#SBATCH --output=myFirstJob.out.%j
#SBATCH --error=myFirstJob.err.%j

# Resource requests
#SBATCH -N 1
#SBATCH -p kimq
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:1
#SBATCH --time=1:00:00

# Display GPU assigned by SLURM
echo "CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES: \$CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES"

# Activate TensorFlow virtual environment
echo "Activating TensorFlow-2.6.2 environment"
source /shared/tensorflow-2.6.2/tf_env/bin/activate

# Run TensorFlow test script
echo "Running testTF.py"
python3 ~/testTFForSlurm/testTF.py

# Deactivate environment
echo "Deactivating TensorFlow-2.6.2 environment"
deactivate
```

To submit this job to SLURM, save the script as `myFirstJob.slurm` (for example) and run:

```
sbatch myFirstJob.slurm
```

1.3 Understanding Key `#SBATCH` Directives

The `#SBATCH` lines at the top of the script tell SLURM what resources you want. They are not shell commands; they are scheduler directives.

1.3.1 Number of Nodes: -N

```
#SBATCH -N 1
```

This requests **1 compute node**. A node is a physical machine that may contain many CPU cores, memory, and possibly GPUs.

More examples:

```
#SBATCH -N 1 # Single-node TensorFlow training
#SBATCH -N 2 # Distributed job across 2 nodes
#SBATCH -N 1-4 # SLURM may allocate anywhere from 1 to 4 nodes
```

1.3.2 Partition (Queue): -p

```
#SBATCH -p kimq
```

The partition selects the *group of nodes* (queue) your job will run on.

On CRADLE, the GPU partition used in the examples below is `gpua30q`. Always verify available partitions with `sinfo`, since partition names are cluster-specific.

Typical partitions might be:

- `compute` → Standard CPU nodes
- `bigmem` → High-memory nodes
- `gpu` or `gpua30q` → GPU-enabled nodes

Examples:

```
#SBATCH -p kimq # Run on GPU nodes in the kimq partition
#SBATCH -p compute # Run on CPU-only nodes
```

1.3.3 GPU Request: -gres

```
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:1
```

This requests **1 GPU** using the generic resource (GRES) mechanism.

More examples:

```
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:1 # One GPU
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:2 # Two GPUs
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:a100:1 # One NVIDIA A100 GPU (if supported)
```

Important: Partition and GPU must match. If you request GPUs but choose a CPU-only partition (e.g., `-p compute` with `-gres=gpu:1`), SLURM cannot satisfy the request and the job will stay pending or fail.

1.3.4 CPU Cores per Task: -cpus-per-task

```
#SBATCH --cpus-per-task=2
```

This requests CPU cores for the main process. In GPU jobs, these CPU cores are commonly used for data loading, preprocessing, and other host-side tasks. If your Python code uses `DataLoader(num_workers > 0)`, you usually need to request enough CPU cores to support it.

More examples:

```
#SBATCH --cpus-per-task=2 # Light data loading
#SBATCH --cpus-per-task=4 # Moderate preprocessing
#SBATCH --cpus-per-task=8 # Heavier data loading or multi-worker pipeline
```

1.3.5 Time Limit: `-time`

```
#SBATCH --time=1:00:00
```

This sets a **wall-clock time limit** of 1 hour for your job. When this time is reached, SLURM terminates the job.

More examples:

```
#SBATCH --time=00:30:00 # 30 minutes
#SBATCH --time=04:00:00 # 4 hours
#SBATCH --time=2-00:00:00 # 2 days
```

1.3.6 Summary Table of Core Directives

1.4 Why Use Python Environments on an HPC Cluster?

On HPC clusters, shared software environments (for example, a shared TensorFlow installation) are usually:

- Optimized for the cluster hardware (correct CUDA, cuDNN, drivers).
- Read-only for users.
- Not modifiable by individual users.

You *cannot* safely run:

```
pip install pandas
```

inside a shared environment such as

```
/shared/tensorflow-2.6.2/tf_env/
```

because:

- It is shared by everyone.
- You do not have write permission.
- Changes could break other users' jobs.

Solution: Clone the shared environment into your home directory, then customize the copy.

Command	Description	Example
Basic Linux Commands		
`pwd`	Print current working directory.	`pwd`
`ls`	List files in current directory.	`ls`
`ls -l`	List files with detailed information.	`ls -l`
`cd <dir>`	Change directory.	`cd projects`
`mkdir -p <dir>`	Create directory (including parent directories if needed).	`mkdir -p data/images`
`cp <src> <dst>`	Copy file or directory.	`cp file.txt backup/`
`mv <src> <dst>`	Move or rename file.	`mv old.txt new.txt`
`rm <file>`	Remove file.	`rm temp.txt`
`rm -rf <file>`	Remove file by force	`rm -rf temp.txt`
`clear`	Clear the terminal screen.	`clear`
`history`	Show previously executed commands.	`history`
`whoami`	Show current username.	`whoami`
`hostname`	Show the current machine/node name.	`hostname`
Account and Security		
`passwd`	Change your login password.	`passwd`
SLURM / HPC Commands		
`sinfo`	Show available partitions and node status.	`sinfo`
`squeue`	Show all running jobs.	`squeue`
`squeue -u <user>`	Show jobs for specific user.	`squeue -u username`
`sbatch <script.sh>`	Submit batch job.	`sbatch train.slurm`
`srun -pty bash`	Start interactive session on compute node.	`srun -pty bash`
`scancel <jobid>`	Cancel a running job.	`scancel 12345`
`scontrol show job <jobid>`	Display detailed information about a job.	`scontrol show job 12345`
GPU and Monitoring		
`nvidia-smi`	Display GPU usage (compute nodes only).	`nvidia-smi`
`tail -f <file>`	Monitor job output in real time.	`tail -f job.out`
Environment and Modules		
`module avail`	List available software modules.	`module avail`
`module load <name>`	Load a software module.	`module load cuda/12.3`
`module list`	Show currently loaded modules.	`module list`
`which python`	Show the path of the active Python interpreter.	`which python`
Storage and Usage		
`du -sh *`	Show directory sizes.	`du -sh *`
`df -h`	Show disk usage.	`df -h`
`quota -s`	Show storage quota.	`quota -s`
`nano <file>`	Edit files.	`nano scheduler.sh`
`less <file>`	View large files interactively.	`less output.log`

Table 1.1: Common Linux and SLURM commands for CRADLE HPC usage

Directive	Controls	Example
`-N`	Number of nodes	`-N 1`
`-p`	Hardware pool	`-p gpua30q`
`-gres`	GPU count	`gpu:1`
`-cpus-per-task`	CPU cores per task	`2`
`-time`	Runtime limit	`1:00:00`

Table 1.2: Core SLURM directives and examples.

Chapter 2

CRADLE COMMAND

2.1 Transferring Files to and from the CRADLE Cluster

When working on the CRADLE HPC cluster, you will often need to move files between your local computer and the cluster. Common examples include:

- Uploading scripts, data files, or configuration files to the cluster.
- Downloading results, logs, or trained models back to your local machine.

This section presents two recommended and commonly used methods:

1. Secure Copy (`scp`)
2. Cloning repositories from GitHub

2.1.1 Using `scp` (Secure Copy)

The `scp` command allows you to securely transfer files between your local machine and the cluster over SSH. It works on Linux, macOS, and Windows (with PowerShell, Git Bash, or WSL).

Transferring a Local File to the Cluster

To copy a file from your local directory to your home directory on the cluster:

```
scp localFileInMyDirectory.txt \
    yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:~/destinationForYourFile/
```

Explanation:

- `localFileInMyDirectory.txt` is the file on your local computer.
- `yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu` is your cluster login.
- `~/destinationForYourFile/` is the target directory on the cluster.

If the destination directory does not exist, create it first after logging in:

```
mkdir -p ~/destinationForYourFil
```

Transferring a File from the Cluster to Your Local Machine

To copy a file from the cluster back to your local directory:

```
scp yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:~/destinationForYourFile/
    localFileInMyDirectory.txt \
    .
```

Here, the dot (`.`) represents your current local directory.

2.1.2 Working with Directories in the Terminal

In both `scp` examples above, the file name refers to a file located in your *current working directory*. You can usually identify this directory by looking at your terminal prompt.

For example:

```
[username@mycomputer:~/Desktop/test]$
```

This indicates that your current directory is:

```
~/Desktop/test
```

You can explicitly check your current directory using:

On Linux or macOS:

```
pwd
```

This prints something like:

```
/home/username/Desktop/test
```

On Windows (PowerShell):

```
cd
```

Understanding your current directory is essential to avoid copying the wrong files or encountering `file not found` errors.

2.1.3 Cloning a GitHub Repository

Instead of manually transferring files, it is often easier to store your project code in a GitHub repository and clone it directly on the cluster.

Example: Cloning a Repository

After logging into the cluster, run:

```
git clone https://github.com/emenriquez/testTFForSlurm
```

This creates a new directory called `testTFForSlurm` containing the full repository.
Advantages of using GitHub:

- Version control and change tracking.
- Easy synchronization across multiple machines.
- Clean separation between code and large datasets.

2.1.4 Recommended Best Practices

- Use `scp` for small files, configuration files, and quick transfers.
- Use GitHub for project code and scripts.

- Avoid transferring very large datasets via `scp`; instead, place them directly on shared cluster storage if available.
- Keep your home directory organized (e.g., `projects/`, `data/`, `results/`).

These practices help ensure efficient workflows and reduce errors when working between your local system and the CRADLE cluster.

2.2 Cloning a Shared TensorFlow Environment

2.2.1 Step 1: Install the cloning tool (one time)

```
pip3 install --user virtualenv-clone
```

This:

- Installs `virtualenv-clone` into your user space.
- Does not require admin/root access.
- Only needs to be run once.

2.2.2 Step 2: Clone the shared environment

```
virtualenv-clone /shared/tensorflow-2.6.2/tf_env ~/myEnvs/tf_env
```

Here:

- `/shared/tensorflow-2.6.2/tf_env/` is the original, optimized, read-only TensorFlow environment.
- `~/myEnvs/tf_env` is your private, writable copy.

What gets copied:

- Python version.
- TensorFlow build (CUDA, cuDNN matched to cluster GPUs).
- All installed dependencies.
- Environment configuration tuned for the cluster.

Advantages:

- Runs as fast as the shared environment.
- You can safely add or upgrade packages.
- No conflicts with other users.

2.2.3 Step 3: Activate the cloned environment

```
source ~/myEnvs/tf_env/bin/activate
```

After activation:

- `python` and `pip` point to your cloned environment.
- Any `pip install` affects only your copy.

The shell prompt typically changes to something like:

```
(tf_env) username@node \$
```

2.2.4 Step 4: Add new packages (example: `pandas`)

With the environment active:

```
pip3 install pandas
```

What happens:

- `pandas` is installed only into `~/myEnvs/tf_env`.
- TensorFlow and CUDA support remain intact.
- The customization is isolated and safe.

You can also add:

```
pip install scikit-learn matplotlib seaborn tqdm
```

2.2.5 Step 5: Use the cloned environment in your SLURM job

Update the activation lines in your job script.

Old (shared environment):

```
echo "Activating TensorFlow-2.6.2 environment"
source /shared/tensorflow-2.6.2/tf_env/bin/activate
```

New (your cloned environment):

```
echo "Activating my custom environment"
source ~/myEnvs/tf_env/bin/activate
```

This ensures:

- Your job sees TensorFlow and any extra packages (e.g., `pandas`).
- You avoid dependency errors at runtime.
- The behavior of your job is reproducible.

Piece	Purpose
Shared environment	Fast, optimized, read-only
Cloned environment	Same speed, user-modifiable
`virtualenv-clone`	Copies entire environment
`pip install`	Safe only in cloned environment
Job script	Must activate your chosen environment

Table 2.1: Conceptual roles of shared and cloned environments.

2.2.6 Mental Model Summary

2.3 Creating Your Own Python Virtual Environment

Sometimes you want a completely independent Python environment. There are two main options; here we focus on standard `venv` and the cloned approach.

2.3.1 Option A (Recommended for CPU-Only): Create from Scratch

Step 1: Choose a location

Create a directory to hold your environments:

```
mkdir -p ~/myEnvs
```

Step 2: Create the virtual environment

```
python3 -m venv ~/myEnvs/myenv
```

This creates something like:

```
~/myEnvs/myenv/
|- bin/
|- lib/
`- pyvenv.cfg
```

Step 3: Activate the environment

```
source ~/myEnvs/myenv/bin/activate
```

Your shell prompt changes to:

```
(myenv) username@login $
```

Step 4: Upgrade `pip` (recommended)

```
pip install --upgrade pip
```

Step 5: Install packages

Example:

```
pip install tensorflow pandas numpy matplotlib
```

Note: On clusters, installing TensorFlow this way may not include GPU support unless CUDA and drivers are correctly matched. For GPU workloads, the cloned shared environment (Option B) is often safer.

Step 6: Use this environment in a SLURM job

In your job script:

```
source ~/myEnvs/myenv/bin/activate
python train.py
```

2.3.2 Option B (Best for GPU): Clone an Optimized Shared Environment

This is essentially the workflow described in Section 2.2.

Step 1: Install the clone tool:

```
pip install --user virtualenv-clone
```

Step 2: Clone the shared environment:

```
virtualenv-clone /shared/tensorflow-2.6.2/tf_env ~/myEnvs/tf_env
```

Step 3: Activate it:

```
source ~/myEnvs/tf_env/bin/activate
```

Step 4: Add packages:

```
pip install pandas scikit-learn seaborn
```

Step 5: Update your SLURM job to activate:

```
source ~/myEnvs/tf_env/bin/activate
```

This preserves CUDA/cuDNN compatibility and performance while allowing you to customize the environment.

2.4 Verifying Your Environment and Common Pitfalls

2.4.1 Verifying Python and GPU Visibility

After activating an environment, verify what `python` and `pip` you are using:

```
which python
which pip
```

For TensorFlow GPU detection:

```
python -c "import tensorflow as tf; print(tf.config.list_physical_devices('GPU'))"
```

Optional but often required: load CUDA module Some clusters require loading a CUDA module before running GPU-enabled PyTorch or TensorFlow jobs. For example:

```
module load cuda/12.3
```

follow the cluster documentation or the instructions provided by your system administrator.

You should see at least one GPU listed when running on a GPU node with correct drivers and environment.

2.4.2 Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Installing packages without activating the environment first.
- Using `pip install -user` inside a virtual environment.
- Mixing Conda environments and `venv` in the same workflow.
- Using the system Python (no virtual environment) for SLURM jobs.
- Requesting GPUs in a CPU-only partition.

2.4.3 Quick Decision Guide

Situation	Best choice
CPU-only work	Option A (new `venv`)
GPU + TensorFlow	Option B (clone shared env)
Cluster-optimized builds	Option B
Full custom control	Option A

Table 2.2: Choosing between creating and cloning environments.

2.5 Using a PyTorch Environment on CRADLE

If your cluster provides a shared PyTorch environment, activate it in your SLURM script using the path provided by your instructor, system administrator, or cluster documentation.

```
source /path/to/shared/pytorch/environment/bin/activate
```

You may also use your own cloned or user-created environment if it includes a CUDA-compatible PyTorch installation.

Then verify that PyTorch can see the GPU:

```
python3 - << 'PY'
import os, torch
print("Torch:", torch.__version__)
print("CUDA available:", torch.cuda.is_available())
print("Device count:", torch.cuda.device_count())
print("CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES:", os.environ.get("CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES"))
if torch.cuda.device_count() > 0:
    for i in range(torch.cuda.device_count()):
        print(f"GPU {i}:", torch.cuda.get_device_name(i))
PY
```

This check confirms that the active Python environment contains a CUDA-enabled PyTorch build and that the GPU allocated by SLURM is visible inside the job.

2.5.1 Minimal GPU Verification Checklist

For a GPU job, verify the following inside the SLURM script:

1. `echo $CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES`

2. `nvidia-smi`
3. Framework-level check such as `torch.cuda.is_available()` or TensorFlow GPU detection

2.6 Using Micromamba and Portable Conda Environments on the HPC Cluster

On many HPC clusters, including CRADLE, traditional Conda/Anaconda installations are discouraged or restricted because they are large, modify shell startup files aggressively, and may conflict with system libraries or CUDA drivers. A lightweight and HPC-friendly alternative is *Micromamba*, a single static binary that implements the Conda ecosystem without requiring a global base environment.

Micromamba allows you to:

- Recreate a Conda environment from a portable YAML file exported on your laptop.
- Install packages into your home directory without administrator rights.
- Activate environments explicitly inside SLURM job scripts.

The overall workflow is:

1. Export a portable Conda environment YAML on your local machine.
2. Copy the YAML file to CRADLE.
3. Install Micromamba in your home directory on CRADLE.
4. Create a Micromamba environment from the YAML file.
5. Activate the environment in your SLURM job scripts.

2.6.1 Exporting a Portable Conda Environment on Your PC

On your local machine where you already use Conda, start by creating a portable YAML description of your environment. Suppose your local environment is called `IR`.

First, activate it:

```
conda activate IR
```

Then export a *portable* environment file using `fromhistory`:

```
conda env export --from-history > IR_portable.yml
```

This creates a file `IR_portable.yml` containing the channels and high-level dependencies (without build hashes). It is much more likely to recreate successfully on a different system such as CRADLE.

2.6.2 Copying the YAML File to CRADLE

Use `scp` or an equivalent file transfer method to copy `IR_portable.yml` to your home directory on CRADLE. For example, from your local terminal:

```
scp IR_portable.yml username@login.cradle.university.edu:~
```

After logging into CRADLE, you should see the file in your home directory:

```
ls ~/IR_portable.yml
```

2.6.3 Installing Micromamba in Your Home Directory

Micromamba is distributed as a single binary, which makes it ideal for installation in a user home directory (no root access required).

Create a directory for the binary:

```
mkdir -p ~/bin
cd ~/bin
```

Download and unpack the latest Micromamba binary (Linux 64-bit):

```
curl -L https://micro.mamba.pm/api/micromamba/linux-64/latest \
  | tar -xvj bin/micromamba
```

Add `$HOME/bin` to your `PATH` in `~/.bashrc`:

```
echo 'export PATH=$HOME/bin:$PATH' >> ~/.bashrc
source ~/.bashrc
```

Verify that `micromamba` is available:

```
micromamba --version
```

2.6.4 Creating a Micromamba Environment from the YAML File

Choose a directory where Micromamba will store its environments, for example:

```
mkdir -p ~/micromamba/envs
```

Initialize Micromamba for Bash (one time):

```
micromamba shell init -s bash -p ~/micromamba
source ~/.bashrc
```

Now create a new environment (for example, `IR_NEW`) from your portable YAML file:

```
micromamba create \
  -f ~/IR_portable.yml \
  -n IR_NEW \
  -p ~/micromamba/envs/IR_NEW
```

Here:

- `~/IR_portable.yml` is the YAML exported on your PC.
- `IR_NEW` is the environment name.
- `~/micromamba/envs/IR_NEW` is the full path Micromamba uses.

2.6.5 Activating the Environment on CRADLE

Once created, you can activate the environment on the CRADLE login node:

```
micromamba activate ~/micromamba/envs/IR_NEW
```

After activation:

- `python` and `pip` refer to the Micromamba environment.
- Any installs via `pip` or `micromamba install` affect only that environment.

You can verify:

```
which python
python --version
pip list
```

2.6.6 Using a Micromamba Environment in a SLURM Job

In a SLURM job script, you should explicitly set the Micromamba root and activate the environment before running Python code. For example:

```
#!/bin/bash
#SBATCH --job-name=ir_gpu_job
#SBATCH --output=ir_gpu_job.out.%j
#SBATCH --error=ir_gpu_job.err.%j
#SBATCH -N 1
#SBATCH -p kimq # GPU partition
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:1 # 1 GPU
#SBATCH --time=02:00:00 # 2 hours

# Ensure Micromamba root is defined
export MAMBA_ROOT_PREFIX=$HOME/micromamba

# Load shell initialization (if micromamba shell init was used)
source $HOME/.bashrc

echo "Host: $(hostname)"
echo "CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES: $CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES"

echo "Activating Micromamba environment IR_NEW"
micromamba activate $HOME/micromamba/envs/IR_NEW

echo "Checking TensorFlow GPU visibility"
python -c "import tensorflow as tf; print(tf.config.list_physical_devices('GPU'))"

echo "Running training script"
python ~/projects/train_ir_model.py
```

This pattern ensures that:

- The correct Micromamba environment is active inside the job.
- GPU visibility can be checked via TensorFlow (or PyTorch).
- The job is reproducible and does not depend on the login-node Conda setup.

2.6.7 Verifying GPU Support Inside the Environment

To confirm that your Micromamba environment has working GPU support for TensorFlow (or another framework), you can run:

```
python -c "import tensorflow as tf; print(tf.config.list_physical_devices('GPU'))"
```

On a GPU node with correct drivers and CUDA libraries, this should list one or more GPU devices. You can also check the low-level GPU visibility with:

```
nvidia-smi
```

2.6.8 Best Practices and Common Pitfalls for Micromamba on HPC

Best practices:

- Export environments from Conda using `-from-history` or `-no-builds` to avoid hardware-specific build strings.
- Use Micromamba to recreate the environment on the cluster, not full Anaconda.
- Keep all Micromamba files under `~/micromamba` or a dedicated directory in your home space.
- Activate environments explicitly inside SLURM job scripts.

Common pitfalls:

- Installing full Anaconda on an HPC login node (disk usage and conflicts).
- Relying on Conda's `base` environment in batch jobs.
- Mixing Conda and Micromamba environments in the same workflow.
- Installing GPU frameworks with incompatible `cudatoolkit` versions; always check which CUDA versions the cluster supports.

Using Micromamba with a portable Conda YAML exported from your local machine gives you a reproducible, HPC-safe way to manage Python environments on CRADLE while respecting cluster policies and maximizing compatibility with the installed NVIDIA drivers and CUDA libraries.

2.7 Worked Examples: Environments and SLURM Job Scripts

This section provides concrete, copy-pasteable examples covering:

1. Creating a new environment.
2. Cloning a shared TensorFlow environment.
3. Selecting (activating) an environment.
4. Installing extra libraries.
5. Checking and verifying resources.
6. Writing SLURM scripts for different resource requirements.

2.7.1 Creating a New CPU-Only Environment

```
# 1. Create a directory to store your environments
mkdir -p ~/myEnvs

# 2. Create a new CPU-only Python virtual environment
python3 -m venv ~/myEnvs/cpu_env

# 3. Activate the environment
source ~/myEnvs/cpu_env/bin/activate

# 4. Upgrade pip
pip install --upgrade pip

# 5. Install some common libraries
pip install numpy scipy pandas matplotlib scikit-learn

# 6. When finished, deactivate
deactivate
```

2.7.2 Cloning a Shared GPU-Optimized TensorFlow Environment

```
# 1. Install the clone tool (only once per user)
pip3 install --user virtualenv-clone

# 2. Create a directory to store your environments (if not already created)
mkdir -p ~/myEnvs

# 3. Clone the shared TensorFlow environment into your home directory
virtualenv-clone /shared/tensorflow-2.6.2/tf_env ~/myEnvs/tf_env

# 4. Activate the cloned environment
source ~/myEnvs/tf_env/bin/activate

# 5. Install extra libraries needed for your project
pip install pandas scikit-learn matplotlib seaborn tqdm

# 6. Deactivate when done
deactivate
```

2.7.3 Selecting an Environment in a Job Script

Activate the CPU-only environment:

```
# Inside your SLURM job script
echo "Activating CPU-only environment"
source ~/myEnvs/cpu_env/bin/activate
```

Activate the cloned GPU TensorFlow environment:

```
# Inside your SLURM job script
echo "Activating GPU TensorFlow environment"
source ~/myEnvs/tf_env/bin/activate
```

2.7.4 Installing Libraries After Environment Activation

Inside the CPU-only environment:

```
source ~/myEnvs/cpu_env/bin/activate
pip install jupyter notebook ipykernel
deactivate
```

Inside the cloned GPU environment:

```
source ~/myEnvs/tf_env/bin/activate
pip install opencv-python pillow tensorboard
deactivate
```

2.7.5 Checking and Verifying Resources

This subsection shows how to verify what resources are available on the cluster and what resources SLURM has actually allocated to your jobs.

Check Available Partitions and Nodes

To see which partitions and nodes exist and their current status:

```
# Show all partitions and their status
sinfo
```

For more detailed information about each node:

```
# Detailed node information
scontrol show nodes
```

Check Your Jobs

To see all of your jobs in the queue:

```
# Show jobs for your user
squeue -u $USER
```

To inspect a specific job by its job ID:

```
# Show a specific job
squeue -j <JOBID>
```

Inspect Resources Allocated by SLURM

To see precisely what resources were allocated to a job:

```
# Show full job allocation details
scontrol show job <JOBID>
```

Look for fields such as `NumNodes`, `NumCPUs`, `Gres`, and `NodeList`.

Check Resources Inside a Job Script

Inside a running job, you can query SLURM environment variables to see what was allocated:

```
echo "Job ID: $SLURM_JOB_ID"
echo "Nodes allocated: $SLURM_NNODES"
echo "Node list: $SLURM_NODELIST"
echo "CPUs per node: $SLURM_CPUS_ON_NODE"
echo "Tasks per node: $SLURM_TASKS_PER_NODE"
echo "Job partition: $SLURM_JOB_PARTITION"
```

Check GPU Allocation

For GPU jobs, it is important to verify which GPUs are visible:

```
# GPUs assigned by SLURM (logical IDs)
echo "CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES: $CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES"

# List visible GPUs and utilization
nvidia-smi
```

Check CPU and Memory Usage

You can inspect CPU and memory characteristics on the node:

```
# CPU info
lscpu

# Memory info
free -h

# Per-node memory summary (first lines of /proc/meminfo)
cat /proc/meminfo | head
```

Check Resources Used by Completed Jobs

After a job finishes, accounting information can be retrieved with `sacct`:

```
# Accounting info for a finished job
sacct -j <JOBID> --format=JobID,JobName,Partition,AllocCPUS,Elapsed,MaxRSS,State
```

This shows how many CPUs were allocated, how long the job ran, peak memory usage (`MaxRSS`), and the final state (e.g., COMPLETED, FAILED, TIMEOUT).

Minimal Resource Debug Job

The following SLURM script does nothing except report which resources it received. It is useful when testing new partitions or debugging allocation issues:

```bash
#!/bin/bash
#SBATCH --job-name=resource_debug
#SBATCH -N 1
#SBATCH -p kimq
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:1
#SBATCH --time=00:10:00

echo "Job ID: $SLURM_JOB_ID"
echo "Node list: $SLURM_NODELIST"
echo "CPUs/node: $SLURM_CPUS_ON_NODE"
echo "GPUs visible: $CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES"

echo "==== nvidia-smi ====="
nvidia-smi

echo "==== lscpu ====="
lscpu

echo "==== memory ====="
free -h
```

Aspect	**CPU**	**Single GPU**	**DataParallel (DP)**	**DistributedDataParallel (DDP)**
Hardware	CPU cores only	1 GPU	Multiple GPUs (1 node)	Multiple GPUs (1+ nodes)
Processes	1	1	1	1 per GPU
GPU usage	None	Full single GPU	Automatic batch split	Explicit per-rank GPU
Multi-node support	No	No	No	Yes
Performance	Slowest	Fast	Medium	Fastest
Scalability	Poor	Limited	Limited	Excellent
Communication	None	None	CPU-based gather/scatter	NCCL all-reduce
Gradient sync	N/A	N/A	Implicit (inefficient)	Explicit (efficient)
Memory efficiency	High	Medium	Low (replication overhead)	High
Fault isolation	N/A	N/A	Poor	Good
Code complexity	Very low	Low	Low	Medium
Launch method	`python`	`python`	`python`	`torchrun` / `srun`
Best use case	Debugging, tests	Small models	Prototyping	Large-scale training
Recommended for HPC	No	Limited	No	Yes

Table 2.3: Comparison of CPU, single-GPU, DataParallel (DP), and DistributedDataParallel (DDP) execution modes in PyTorch.

Aspect	**CPU**	**Single GPU**	**DataParallel (DP)**	**DistributedDataParallel (DDP)**
Hardware	CPU cores only	1 GPU	Multiple GPUs (1 node)	Multiple GPUs (1+ nodes)
Processes	1	1	1	1 per GPU
GPU usage	None	Full single GPU	Automatic batch split	Explicit per-rank GPU
Multi-node support	No	No	No	Yes
Performance	Slowest	Fast	Medium	Fastest
Scalability	Poor	Limited	Limited	Excellent
Communication	None	None	Gather/scatter overhead	NCCL all-reduce
Gradient sync	N/A	N/A	Implicit (less efficient)	Explicit (efficient)
Memory efficiency	High	Medium	Lower (replication overhead)	Medium (replicated per GPU)
Fault isolation	N/A	N/A	Poor	Better
Code complexity	Very low	Low	Low	Medium
Launch method	`python`	`python`	`python`	`torchrun`/`srun`
Best use case	Debugging, tests	Small models	Prototyping	Large-scale training
Recommended for HPC	No	Limited	No	Yes

Table 2.4: Comparison of CPU, single-GPU, DataParallel (DP), and DistributedDataParallel (DDP) execution modes in PyTorch.

2.8 PyTorch DataParallel (DP) on SLURM

This section describes PyTorch **DataParallel (DP)**, a simpler multi-GPU approach compared to Distributed Data Parallel (DDP). DP uses a *single Python process* and automatically splits each batch across multiple GPUs on the same node.

Important: DP is suitable for quick experiments on a *single node* only. For serious training, large models, or multi-node jobs, prefer DDP (Section 2.9).

2.8.1 When to Use DataParallel

- Single node with multiple GPUs.
- Prototyping or debugging multi-GPU behavior.
- Minimal code changes from single-GPU training.

2.8.2 When *Not* to Use DataParallel

- Multi-node training (DP does not scale across nodes).
- Large models or long training runs (DDP is faster and more stable).
- When precise performance benchmarking matters.

2.8.3 Minimal DataParallel Training Skeleton

Save as `train_dp.py`. This example assumes a single node with multiple GPUs.

Listing 2.1: Minimal PyTorch DataParallel training skeleton (`train_dp.py`)

```python
import torch
import torch.nn as nn
from torch.utils.data import DataLoader

def build_model():
    # Replace with your FCN / VAE model
    return nn.Identity()

def build_dataset(split="train"):
    # Replace with your dataset
    raise NotImplementedError

def main():
    device = torch.device("cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else "cpu")

    model = build_model()

    if torch.cuda.device_count() > 1:
        print(f"Using DataParallel on {torch.cuda.device_count()} GPUs")
        model = nn.DataParallel(model)

    model = model.to(device)

    train_ds = build_dataset("train")
    train_loader = DataLoader(
        train_ds,
        batch_size=16,
        shuffle=True,
        num_workers=4,
        pin_memory=True,
        drop_last=True,
    )

    optim = torch.optim.Adam(model.parameters(), lr=1e-3)

    model.train()
    for epoch in range(5):
        for batch in train_loader:
            X, Y = batch
            X = X.to(device, non_blocking=True)
            Y = Y.to(device, non_blocking=True)

            optim.zero_grad(set_to_none=True)
            Yhat = model(X)
            loss = torch.mean((Yhat - Y) ** 2)
            loss.backward()
            optim.step()

        print(f"Epoch {epoch} done. loss={loss.item():.6f}")

if __name__ == "__main__":
    main()
```

2.8.4 SLURM Script for DataParallel (single node)

DP requires **one Python process only**. Do *not* use `torchrun` or multiple tasks.

Listing 2.2: SLURM script for DataParallel (`dp_1node.slurm`)

```
#!/bin/bash
#SBATCH --job-name=dp_1node
#SBATCH --output=dp_1node.out.%j
#SBATCH --error=dp_1node.err.%j
#SBATCH -N 1
#SBATCH -p kimq
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:4
#SBATCH --cpus-per-task=8
#SBATCH --time=04:00:00

echo "Host: \$(hostname)"
echo "CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES: \$CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES"

source ~/myEnvs/tf_env/bin/activate

export OMP_NUM_THREADS=\$SLURM_CPUS_PER_TASK

# Single process only
python train_dp.py

deactivate
```

2.8.5 DP vs DDP: Practical Comparison

Feature	DataParallel (DP)	DistributedDataParallel (DDP)
Processes	1 total	1 per GPU
Multi-node support	No	Yes
Performance	Slower	Faster
Scalability	Limited	Excellent
Failure isolation	Poor	Good
Recommended for	Prototyping	Production / research

Table 2.5: Comparison between DataParallel and DistributedDataParallel.

2.8.6 Common DP Pitfalls

- Do not combine DP with `torchrun` or `srun -n > 1`.
- Expect slower scaling beyond 2–4 GPUs.
- Avoid DP for multi-node jobs.
- Always move the model to GPU *after* wrapping with `DataParallel`.

2.8.7 Rule of Thumb

- **1 node, quick test** → DataParallel

- **Anything serious or multi-node** → DDP

2.9 PyTorch Distributed Data Parallel (DDP) on SLURM

This section shows a minimal, practical recipe for PyTorch DDP on an HPC cluster. DDP runs one Python process per GPU and synchronizes gradients efficiently.

2.9.1 What You Need (Checklist)

- Request **multiple GPUs** in SLURM (e.g., `-gres=gpu:4`).

- Launch with `torchrun` (recommended) or `srun` + environment variables.

- In Python: call `init_process_group`, set the per-rank GPU, wrap model with `DistributedDataParallel`.

- Use `DistributedSampler` for training (and validation if you want correct global metrics quickly).

2.9.2 Minimal DDP Training Skeleton (single file)

Save as `train_ddp.py`. Replace `build_model()`, `build_dataset()`, and the loss/optimizer with your own code.

Listing 2.3: Minimal PyTorch DDP training skeleton (`train_ddp.py`)

```python
import os
import torch
import torch.nn as nn
import torch.distributed as dist
from torch.nn.parallel import DistributedDataParallel as DDP
from torch.utils.data import DataLoader
from torch.utils.data.distributed import DistributedSampler

# -------------------------
# 1) DDP setup / teardown
# -------------------------
def ddp_setup():
    """
    Works with: torchrun (sets RANK, LOCAL_RANK, WORLD_SIZE, MASTER_ADDR, MASTER_PORT
        ).
    """
    if dist.is_available() and not dist.is_initialized():
        dist.init_process_group(backend="nccl") # GPUs -> nccl

    rank = int(os.environ.get("RANK", "0"))
    local_rank = int(os.environ.get("LOCAL_RANK", "0"))
    world_size = int(os.environ.get("WORLD_SIZE", "1"))

    if torch.cuda.is_available():
        torch.cuda.set_device(local_rank)
        device = torch.device(f"cuda:{local_rank}")
    else:
        device = torch.device("cpu")

    return device, rank, local_rank, world_size

def ddp_cleanup():
    if dist.is_available() and dist.is_initialized():
        dist.destroy_process_group()

# -------------------------
# 2) Your builders (replace)
# -------------------------
def build_model():
    # Replace with your FCN/VAE model builder
    return nn.Identity()

def build_dataset(split="train"):
    # Replace with your dataset (e.g., CleanImageFolder / PairedImageFolder)
    # Must return a torch.utils.data.Dataset
    raise NotImplementedError

# -------------------------
# 3) Main training loop
# -------------------------
def main():
    device, rank, local_rank, world = ddp_setup()
    is_ddp = (world > 1)

    model = build_model().to(device)
    if is_ddp:
        model = DDP(model, device_ids=[local_rank], output_device=local_rank)

```

2.9.3 SLURM Script for DDP (single node, 4 GPUs)

This launches **one process per GPU** on the same node.

Listing 2.4: SLURM script for DDP on 1 node (`ddp_1node.slurm`)

```bash
#!/bin/bash
#SBATCH --job-name=ddp_1node
#SBATCH --output=ddp_1node.out.%j
#SBATCH --error=ddp_1node.err.%j
#SBATCH -N 1
#SBATCH -p kimq
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:4
#SBATCH --cpus-per-task=4
#SBATCH --time=04:00:00

echo "Host: \$(hostname)"
echo "Node list: \$SLURM_NODELIST"
echo "CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES: \$CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES"

source ~/myEnvs/tf_env/bin/activate

# One process per GPU:
export OMP_NUM_THREADS=\$SLURM_CPUS_PER_TASK

# torchrun is recommended.
# --standalone works for single-node. For multi-node, use rendezvous settings shown below.
srun torchrun \
  --standalone \
  --nproc_per_node=4 \
  train_ddp.py

deactivate
```

2.9.4 SLURM Script for DDP (2 nodes, 4 GPUs per node)

For multi-node DDP, you need a rendezvous endpoint (master address/port). A common pattern is to use the first node in `$SLURM_NODELIST` as the master.

Listing 2.5: SLURM script for DDP on 2 nodes (`ddp_2node.slurm`)

```
#!/bin/bash
#SBATCH --job-name=ddp_2node
#SBATCH --output=ddp_2node.out.%j
#SBATCH --error=ddp_2node.err.%j
#SBATCH -N 2
#SBATCH -p kimq
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:4
#SBATCH --cpus-per-task=4
#SBATCH --time=06:00:00

source ~/myEnvs/tf_env/bin/activate

# Pick master node and port
MASTER_ADDR=\$(scontrol show hostnames "\$SLURM_NODELIST" | head -n 1)
MASTER_PORT=29500

echo "MASTER_ADDR=\$MASTER_ADDR"
echo "MASTER_PORT=\$MASTER_PORT"

export OMP_NUM_THREADS=\$SLURM_CPUS_PER_TASK

# Total processes = nodes * gpus_per_node = 2 * 4 = 8
srun torchrun \
  --nnodes=2 \
  --nproc_per_node=4 \
  --rdzv_backend=c10d \
  --rdzv_endpoint=\$MASTER_ADDR:\$MASTER_PORT \
  train_ddp.py

deactivate
```

2.9.5 Common DDP Pitfalls (Fast Debug List)

- **Do not use `DataParallel` with DDP.** Use one or the other.
- **Call `DistributedSampler(...)` for training** and **call `set_epoch(epoch)`** each epoch.
- **Set the per-process GPU** via `LOCAL_RANK` and `torch.cuda.set_device(local_rank)`.
- **Print/checkpoint only on rank 0** to avoid duplicates and file corruption.
- If validation metrics must be global, either:
  - use `DistributedSampler` for validation and `all_reduce` metric sums, or
  - run validation only on rank 0 (simpler but slower).

Chapter 3

Example Commands

3.1 Example Commands for File Transfer

This chapter provides practical, copy-pasteable examples for transferring files and directories between your local machine and the CRADLE cluster. These commands are typically run from a local terminal, not inside a SLURM job.

Useful HPC Commands for SLURM, Modules, Conda, and Remote Workflows

The following commands are commonly used when working on an HPC cluster. They help users inspect cluster resources, manage software modules, configure Conda environments, transfer files, and monitor SLURM jobs.

For additional examples of secure file transfer using `scp`, see the following reference:
https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/linux-unix/scp-command-in-linux-with-examples/

```

############################
# Inspect Cluster Resources
############################

# Show available partitions (queues), nodes, and their status
sinfo

# Example output fields:
# PARTITION -> queue name
# AVAIL -> whether it is available
# NODES -> number of nodes
# STATE -> idle, mix, alloc, drain


##################################
# Environment Modules Management
##################################

# Show all available software modules
module avail

# Show modules currently loaded in your environment
module list
```

```

# Load a software module (example: CUDA toolkit)
module load cuda/12.3

# Unload a specific module
module unload cuda/12.3

# Remove all loaded modules and reset the module environment
module purge


##################################
# Creating Project Directories
##################################

# Create a main project directory
mkdir -p ~/project_workspace

# Create a directory for storing datasets
## -p means create parent directories as needed
mkdir -p ~/project_workspace/Data_Source


##################################
# Installing Conda (Optional)
##################################

# Download the full Anaconda distribution
wget https://repo.anaconda.com/archive/Anaconda3-2025.12-2-Linux-x86_64.sh

# OR download the lightweight Miniconda installer
wget https://repo.anaconda.com/miniconda/Miniconda3-latest-Linux-x86_64.sh


##################################
# Conda Environment Setup
##################################

# Enable conda in the current shell session
# (required if conda is installed but not automatically initialized)
eval "$(conda shell.bash hook)"

# Verify conda installation
conda --version

# Check which Python interpreter is currently active
# Useful for confirming the active Conda environment
which python
which python3

# Make conda initialization permanent for future logins
conda init bash


```

```
##################################
# Disable Automatic Base Environment
##################################

# Prevent the base environment from activating automatically
conda config --set auto_activate_base false

# Reload shell configuration
source ~/.bashrc




##################################
# Running Jupyter Notebook on HPC
##################################

# Start a Jupyter notebook on a remote machine
jupyter notebook --no-browser --port=8888


##################################
# Create SSH Tunnel from Local Machine
##################################

# Forward local port 8888 to the remote HPC node
ssh -L 8888:localhost:8888 username@login.cluster.edu

# If Jupyter is running on a compute node, first identify that node name
hostname

# Then create an SSH tunnel to that specific node through the login node
ssh -L 8888:localhost:8888 -J username@login.cluster.edu username@compute-node

# Open the URL printed by Jupyter in your local browser
http://localhost:8888/tree?token=YOUR_TOKEN_HERE



##################################
# Copy Files and Folders to HPC with scp
##################################

# Step 1: Log in to the HPC cluster and create destination directories
ssh yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu

mkdir -p ~/project_workspace
mkdir -p ~/project_workspace/envs

# Step 2: From your local computer, copy files to the cluster
# Quotes are used because Windows paths often contain spaces
```

```

# Copy an entire local directory to the HPC cluster
# The -r option means "recursive", so the full folder and its contents are copied
scp -r "C:\Users\...\Data_Source" \
    yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:/home/yourUserName/project_workspace

# Copy a single local text file
scp "C:\Users\...\mask_rcnn\install_steps.txt" \
    yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:/home/yourUserName/project_workspace/envs

# Copy another single local file
scp "C:\Users\...\Projects\HPC\install_hpc.txt" \
    yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:/home/yourUserName/project_workspace/envs


##################################
# Fix Windows Line Ending Issues
##################################

# Convert Windows CRLF line endings to Linux format
dos2unix job_script.sh

# Alternative method if dos2unix is unavailable
sed -i 's/\r$//' job_script.sh


##################################
# SLURM Job Monitoring
##################################

# Check whether a specific job is still in the queue
squeue -j JOB_ID

# Show accounting information for a finished job
# (may be disabled on some clusters)
sacct -j JOB_ID


##################################
# Inspect Job Output Files
##################################

# List files in the current directory
ls

# Display the job's standard output
cat job_output.out

# Display the job's error output
cat job_error.err

# View large output files interactively
```

```
less job_output.out
```

These commands form a typical workflow when interacting with an HPC cluster: checking available resources, managing software modules and environments, running interactive applications such as Jupyter, and monitoring SLURM jobs.

3.1.1 Copy files from/to CRADLE

Copying a Single File from Local Machine to CRADLE

```
scp my_script.py \
    yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:/home/yourUserName/projects/
```

This copies `my_script.py` from your current local directory into `/home/yourUserName/projects/` on the cluster.

Copying a Single File from CRADLE to Local Machine

```
scp yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:/home/yourUserName/projects/results.txt \
    .
```

The dot (`.`) represents your current local directory.

Copying an Entire Directory to CRADLE

To recursively copy a directory (for example, a project folder):

```
scp -r myProjectFolder/ \
    yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:/home/yourUserName/projects/
```

This creates `/home/yourUserName/projects/myProjectFolder/` on the cluster.

Copying an Entire Directory from CRADLE to Local Machine

```
scp -r yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:/home/yourUserName/projects/
    myProjectFolder/ \
    ~/Desktop/
```

Copying an Entire Directory from CRADLE to the Current Local Folder

```
# Copy a full directory from CRADLE to the current folder on your local machine
scp -r yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:/home/yourUserName/projects/
    myProjectFolder/ .
```

Copying a Directory from CRADLE Without Replacing Existing Local Files

```
# Copy a directory from CRADLE to the current local folder
# Existing local files will not be overwritten
rsync -av --progress --ignore-existing yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:/home
    /yourUserName/projects/myProjectFolder/ .

# Copy only the contents inside myProjectFolder
rsync -av --ignore-existing user@server:/path/myProjectFolder/ .

# Copy the whole myProjectFolder directory
rsync -av --ignore-existing user@server:/path/myProjectFolder .
```

Copying a Directory from CRADLE Without Replacing Existing Local Files

```
# rsync options:
# -a : archive mode; copies recursively and preserves file metadata
# -v : verbose; shows what is being transferred
# -h : human-readable file sizes
# --progress : show transfer progress
# --ignore-existing : skip files that already exist in the destination

rsync -avh --progress --ignore-existing yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:/
    home/yourUserName/projects/myProjectFolder/ .
```

Transferring Job Output After Completion

After a SLURM job finishes, you often want to retrieve output files such as logs or trained models.

```
scp yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:/home/yourUserName/slurm_outputs/myJob.
    out.123456 \
    .
```

Here, `123456` is the SLURM job ID.

Copying Files Using Wildcards

You can use wildcards to transfer multiple files at once:

```
scp yourUserName@login.cradle.university.edu:/home/yourUserName/slurm_outputs/*.out.*
     \
    .
```

This copies all SLURM output files in the directory.

Move Folders

```
# Move source folders into a destination folder
mv source_folder1 source_folder2 destination_folder/
```

Recommended Workflow with SLURM Jobs

A typical workflow looks like this:

1. Copy scripts to CRADLE using `scp` or `git clone`.
2. Submit the job using `sbatch`.
3. Monitor the job with `squeue`.
4. Copy results back to your local machine using `scp`.

Important Note: File transfers should generally be performed from the *login node*, not from inside running compute jobs, unless explicitly required.

3.1.2 Installing Anaconda or Miniconda on CRADLE

Download the installer from the login node:

```
cd /home/yourUserName

# Full Anaconda distribution
wget https://repo.anaconda.com/archive/Anaconda3-2025.12-2-Linux-x86_64.sh

# OR lightweight Miniconda installer
wget https://repo.anaconda.com/miniconda/Miniconda3-latest-Linux-x86_64.sh

# Clear Screan
clear
```

Run the installer:

```
# Example for Anaconda
bash Anaconda3-2025.12-2-Linux-x86_64.sh

# Example for Miniconda
bash Miniconda3-latest-Linux-x86_64.sh


# Retart Terminal or run cmd:
source ~/.bashrc
```

Activating Conda in the Current Session

If you chose not to initialize Conda automatically during installation, enable it manually in the current shell:

Listing 3.1: Sample Code

```

eval "\$(/home/yourUserName/anaconda3/bin/conda shell.bash hook)"
conda --version

# Deactivate conda environment
conda deactivate

# Show current directory
pwd

# Show available cluster resources
```

```
sinfo

# Show all queued/running jobs
squeue

# Show queued/running jobs for a specific user
squeue -u $USER
```

Making Conda Available for Future Logins

To make Conda automatically available in every login session:

```
/home/yourUserName/anaconda3/bin/conda init bash
source ~/.bashrc
conda --version
```

3.1.3 Example SLURM Job Script Using a Conda Environment

The following example shows how to run a GPU-enabled Python program on the CRADLE cluster using a Conda environment.

Listing 3.2: Sample Code

```
[
# Don't forget to have the folders first ****
# mkdir -p logs ]

#!/bin/bash
#SBATCH --job-name=maskrcnn
#SBATCH --output=logs/maskrcnn.out.%j
#SBATCH --error=logs/maskrcnn.err.%j
#SBATCH -N 1
#SBATCH -p gpua30q
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:1
#SBATCH --cpus-per-task=2
#SBATCH --time=02:00:00

echo "Host: $(hostname)"
echo "CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES: $CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES"

# initialize conda
# source ~/anaconda3/etc/profile.d/conda.sh
# OR
source \$(conda info --base)/etc/profile.d/conda.sh

# activate environment
conda activate mask_rcnn

echo "Python path: \$(which python)"

python train_maskrcnn.py
\end{codeblock}
```

```
    \subsubsection{Select GPU}
    \begin{codeblock}[numbers=none,xleftmargin=0pt,framexleftmargin=0pt]
    # Select GPU (Optional) ********
    #SBATCH --nodelist=gpu007
```

gpuinfo.sh

```
# save as gpuinfo.sh
#!/bin/bash
#SBATCH --job-name=gpuinfo
#SBATCH --output=gpuinfo.out.%j
#SBATCH --error=gpuinfo.err.%j
#SBATCH -p gpuq
#SBATCH --nodelist=gpu007
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:1
#SBATCH -c 1
#SBATCH --mem=2G
#SBATCH -t 00:05:00

echo "Date: \$(date)"
echo "Host: \$(hostname)"
echo "CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES=\$CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES"

nvidia-smi
nvidia-smi --query-gpu=index,name,memory.total,memory.free,memory.used,utilization.gpu --
    format=csv
```

This script requests one GPU from the `gpua30q` partition and activates the `mask_rcnn` Conda environment before running the training script.

3.1.4 Sample Run code for sh

Listing 3.3: Sample Code

```
    # Go to the working folder
    cd folder

    # List files in the current folder
    ls

    # List files in the current folder, organized with directories first
    ls -lh --group-directories-first

    # Remove old log directory
    rm -rf logs

    # Move a folder into another folder
    mv folder to_folder/

    # Move a file into another folder
    mv file to_folder/

    # Rename a folder
```

```
mv folder_old folder_new

# Rename a file
mv file_old file_new

# Create a fresh log directory
mkdir -p logs

# Open the scheduler script for editing
nano scheduler.sh

# Convert Windows line endings to Unix line endings
dos2unix scheduler.sh

# Submit the job to Slurm
sbatch scheduler.sh

# Check running or queued jobs for a specific user
squeue -u $USER
```

```
--partition=gpuq
or
-p gpuq

--nodelist=gpu001
or
-w gpu001

--gres=gpu:1 request 1 GPU
-N 1 number of nodes
-c 4 CPUs per task
--cpus-per-task=4 same as above
--mem=16G memory
--time=01:00:00 wall time
--job-name=name job name
--output=file standard output file
--error=file error file

sbatch -p gpuq --nodelist=gpu003 --gres=gpu:1 -c 4 --mem=16G --time=02:00:00 myjob.sh

# Equivalent short form
sbatch -p gpuq -w gpu003 --gres=gpu:1 -c 4 --mem=16G --time=02:00:00 myjob.sh


# Full Name
squeue -u username -o "%.18i %.12P %.35j %.12u %.2t %.10M %.6D %R"


# Time remaining
scontrol show job 45987 | grep -E "RunTime|TimeLimit|StartTime|EndTime"



for job in 46001 45999 45998 45997 45995 46000; do
    echo "============================================================"
    echo "JobID: $job"
    scontrol show job "$job" | grep -E "JobId=|JobName=|Partition=|RunTime=|TimeLimit
        =|StartTime=|EndTime=|NodeList="
done


# Show drained/down nodes and their reasons
sinfo -R

# Show node state, GPU resources, and drain reason
sinfo -N -p gpuq,sxmq,kimq -o "%P %N %T %G %E"
```

Using `tmux` for Long File Transfers

When copying large files or folders between systems, the transfer may stop if the terminal is closed. To avoid this, use `tmux`, which keeps the command running in a separate terminal session.

```
tmux new -s transfer
```

The command above creates a new `tmux` session named `transfer`. Inside this session, run the file transfer command, for example:

```
scp -r -o MACs=hmac-sha2-256 Data_Source username@remote.server.edu:/home/username/
    project_folder
```

To detach from the session without stopping the transfer, press:

```
Ctrl + b
d
```

The transfer will continue running in the background. To reconnect to the same session later, use:

```
tmux attach -t transfer
```

To list active `tmux` sessions, use:

```
tmux ls
```

After the transfer finishes, close the session by typing:

```
exit
```

Using `rsync` with `tmux` for Safe Dataset Transfer

For large dataset transfers, `rsync` is preferred over `scp` because it can skip files that already exist at the destination. Using `tmux` is also helpful because the transfer can continue running even if the terminal disconnects.

```
# Start a tmux session for the transfer
tmux new -s transfer

# Create the destination folder on the remote HPC
ssh -o MACs=hmac-sha2-256 username@ls6.tacc.utexas.edu \
"mkdir -p /work/projectID/username/ls6/project_folder/Data_Source/AMR_DATASET"

# Dry run first:
# This only shows which files would be copied.
# It does not actually copy anything because of the -n option.
rsync -avhn --progress --ignore-existing \
  -e "ssh -o MACs=hmac-sha2-256" \
  AMR_DATASET/ \
  username@ls6.tacc.utexas.edu:/work/projectID/username/ls6/project_folder/Data_Source/
      AMR_DATASET/

# Actual transfer:
# Same command as above, but without -n.
# This copies missing files and skips files that already exist.
rsync -avh --progress --ignore-existing \
  -e "ssh -o MACs=hmac-sha2-256" \
  AMR_DATASET/ \
  username@ls6.tacc.utexas.edu:/work/projectID/username/ls6/project_folder/Data_Source/
      AMR_DATASET/

# Detach from tmux without stopping the transfer:
# Press Ctrl+b, then press d





# Exclude both .pth files and files larger than 20 MB ***
rsync -av --exclude='*.pth' --max-size=20M source_folder/ username@remote:/path/to/
    destination/





# Reconnect later to the same tmux session
tmux attach -t transfer

# After the transfer is finished, close the tmux session
exit
```

Here, `-n` means dry run, so the first `rsync` command only previews the transfer. The second command removes `-n`, so it performs the actual copy. The option `-ignore-existing` prevents existing destination files from being replaced.

3.1.5 Launching Jupyter Notebook on CRADLE

Start Jupyter Notebook on the remote machine (login or compute node):

```
jupyter notebook --no-browser --port=8888
```

The output will display a URL containing an authentication token, for example:

```
http://localhost:8888/tree?token=2c23d0
```

Creating an SSH Tunnel from Your Local Machine

On your local computer (Windows, macOS, or Linux), create a secure tunnel:

```
ssh -L 8888:localhost:8888 user@login.cradle.university.edu
```

This forwards local port 8888 on your computer to port 8888 on the CRADLE server.

Accessing Jupyter in Your Web Browser

After the SSH tunnel is established, open your browser and navigate to:

```
http://localhost:8888/tree?token=2c23d0
```

Paste the token exactly as shown in the Jupyter output on CRADLE.

3.1.6 Troubleshooting Deleting a Folder

```
# Try deleting the folder
rm -rf logs

# If permission is denied, give yourself read, write, and execute permission
chmod -R u+rwx logs

# Delete the folder again
rm -rf logs
```

```
# Check write permission for the current folder
ls -ld .

# Check permission for the parent folder
ls -ld ..

# Add write permission for the current user
chmod u+w .
```

3.1.7 Single Node, CPU-Only Job

```
#!/bin/bash
#SBATCH --job-name=cpu_only_job
#SBATCH --output=cpu_only_job.out.%j
#SBATCH --error=cpu_only_job.err.%j
#SBATCH -N 1
#SBATCH -p compute # CPU-only partition
#SBATCH --time=01:00:00 # 1 hour

echo "Host: \$(hostname)"
echo "Using CPU-only environment"
source ~/myEnvs/cpu_env/bin/activate

echo "Running CPU-only Python script"
python ~/projects/my_cpu_script.py

echo "Deactivating environment"
deactivate
```

Checking and Managing Modules on HPC

HPC systems often use environment modules to load software such as CUDA, Python, compilers, and MPI libraries. The following commands are useful for checking available modules, viewing loaded modules, and loading or unloading specific software.

```
# Show all available modules
module avail

# Show available CUDA modules only
module avail cuda

# Show currently loaded modules
module list

# Load a specific module
module load cuda/12.8

# Check loaded modules again
module list

# Unload a specific module
module unload cuda

# Remove all loaded modules
module purge

# Reload the default TACC environment if needed
module load TACC

# Save the currently loaded collection of modules
module save


echo \$HOME # Without backslash
echo \$WORK # Without backslash
echo \$SCRATCH # Without backslash

cdh # Goto home directory
cdw # Goto work directory
cds # Goto scratch directory


conda --version
#conda 25.11.1
conda info --base
#/work/11394/user/wd/shahriar/anaconda3


# idle gpu
sinfo -t idle
```

Single Node, Single GPU Job

```
#!/bin/bash
#SBATCH --job-name=single_gpu_job
#SBATCH --output=single_gpu_job.out.%j
#SBATCH --error=single_gpu_job.err.%j
#SBATCH -N 1
#SBATCH -p kimq # GPU partition
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:1 # 1 GPU
#SBATCH --time=02:00:00 # 2 hours

echo "Host: $(hostname)"
echo "CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES: $CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES"

echo "Activating GPU TensorFlow environment"
source ~/myEnvs/tf_env/bin/activate

echo "Running single-GPU training script"
python ~/projects/train_single_gpu.py

echo "Deactivating environment"
deactivate
```

Single Node, Multiple GPUs (e.g., 4 GPUs)

```
#!/bin/bash
#SBATCH --job-name=multi_gpu_job
#SBATCH --output=multi_gpu_job.out.%j
#SBATCH --error=multi_gpu_job.err.%j
#SBATCH -N 1
#SBATCH -p kimq # GPU partition
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:4 # 4 GPUs on the same node
#SBATCH --time=04:00:00 # 4 hours

echo "Host: $(hostname)"
echo "CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES: $CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES"

echo "Activating GPU TensorFlow environment"
source ~/myEnvs/tf_env/bin/activate

echo "Running multi-GPU training script (e.g., data parallel)"
python ~/projects/train_multi_gpu.py --num-gpus 4

echo "Deactivating environment"
deactivate
```

Multiple Nodes, CPU-Only (e.g., MPI or Distributed CPU Job)

```bash
#!/bin/bash
#SBATCH --job-name=cpu_multi_node_job
#SBATCH --output=cpu_multi_node_job.out.%j
#SBATCH --error=cpu_multi_node_job.err.%j
#SBATCH -N 2 # 2 nodes
#SBATCH -p compute # CPU-only partition
#SBATCH --time=03:00:00 # 3 hours

echo "SLURM_NODELIST: $SLURM_NODELIST"
echo "SLURM_NNODES: $SLURM_NNODES"

echo "Activating CPU-only environment"
source ~/myEnvs/cpu_env/bin/activate

# Example: launch an MPI or distributed job
# (replace with your actual launcher, e.g., srun mpirun, torchrun, etc.)
echo "Running distributed CPU job"
srun python ~/projects/distributed_cpu_job.py

echo "Deactivating environment"
deactivate
```

Multiple Nodes, Multiple GPUs (Distributed GPU Training)

```bash
#!/bin/bash
#SBATCH --job-name=multi_node_multi_gpu
#SBATCH --output=multi_node_multi_gpu.out.%j
#SBATCH --error=multi_node_multi_gpu.err.%j
#SBATCH -N 2 # 2 nodes
#SBATCH -p kimq # GPU partition
#SBATCH --gres=gpu:4 # 4 GPUs per node (total 8 GPUs)
#SBATCH --time=06:00:00 # 6 hours

echo "SLURM_NODELIST: $SLURM_NODELIST"
echo "SLURM_NNODES: $SLURM_NNODES"
echo "CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES: $CUDA_VISIBLE_DEVICES"

echo "Activating GPU TensorFlow environment"
source ~/myEnvs/tf_env/bin/activate

# Example using srun to launch a distributed training job
# Replace with your actual distributed launcher (e.g., torchrun, horovodrun)
echo "Running multi-node, multi-GPU training"
srun python ~/projects/train_distributed_gpu.py \
     --nodes $SLURM_NNODES \
     --gpus-per-node 4

echo "Deactivating environment"
deactivate
```

3.1.8 Quick Mapping: Which Example to Use?

- **Create new CPU environment**: Listing in Section 2.7.1.
- **Clone shared GPU TF environment**: Listing in Section 2.7.2.
- **CPU-only job**: Section 3.1.7.
- **Single-GPU job**: Section 3.1.7.
- **Single node, multiple GPUs**: Section 3.1.7.
- **Multi-node CPU job**: Section 3.1.7.
- **Multi-node, multi-GPU job**: Section 3.1.7.

3.2 Summary

In this tutorial, you have seen:

- How to write and submit a basic SLURM job script that runs a TensorFlow program.
- How to interpret key `#SBATCH` directives: number of nodes, partition, GPU requests, and time limits.
- Why shared environments on HPC clusters are read-only and how to safely extend them by cloning to your home directory.
- How to create your own Python virtual environments from scratch and how to connect them to SLURM job scripts.

This workflow lets you run fast, GPU-enabled jobs using cluster-optimized software while keeping your custom Python packages isolated and safe.

Index

`-cpus-per-task`, 7
`-gres`, 7
`-time`, 8
`-N`, 7
`-p`, 7
#SBATCH directives, 5

Conda environment
    IR, 18
CRADLE, 5
CUDA, 8
cuDNN, 8

environment
    shared, 6

GPU
    partition, 7
    request, 7
GPU workload, 5
GRES, 7

HPC cluster, 1

Micromamba, 18

node
    compute, 7

pandas, 14
partition, 7
Python environment, 15

sacct, 24
scheduler
    directives, 6
scp, 11, 18
SLURM, 1
    batch script, 5
    environment variables, 23
    resources, 23
ssh, 5

TensorFlow, 5
    shared installation, 8
time limit, 8

university cluster, 5

venv, 15
virtual environment, 5
virtualenv-clone, 13
VPN, 5